Cloud Accounting for South African Businesses

Competitive Feature Comparison

ISAFlow vs Sage vs QuickBooks vs Xero

South Africa Edition — April 2026

ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Cloud Accounting	Business Cloud	Online	Accounting
app.isaflow.co.za	From R240/mo	From R250/mo	From R299/mo

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Executive Summary

This document provides a feature-by-feature comparison of ISAFlow against the three leading cloud accounting platforms in South Africa: Sage Business Cloud, QuickBooks Online, and Xero.

ISAFlow is purpose-built for South African businesses, with integrated payroll, SARS compliance, BEE reporting, fixed asset management, and advanced AI capabilities — all included in the base price. Key differentiators include multi-entity consolidation, three-way procurement matching, AI-powered document capture with Vision Language Models, and a comprehensive reporting suite.

Legend: YES = Included | Partial / Add-on / Tier-locked | NO = Not available

Std = Standard | Ess+ = Essentials+ | Plus+ = Plus | Adv = Advanced | Prem = Premium | Add-on = Paid extra | 3rd party = Via integration

Feature Score Summary by Module

Module	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
1. Dashboard & KPIs	6/6	2.5/6	2.5/6	2.5/6
2. General Ledger	9/9	5/9	6.5/9	6/9
3. Customers / AR	13/13	8/13	8.5/13	10/13
4. Suppliers / AP	9/9	3/9	2/9	5.5/9
5. Banking & Reconciliation	10/10	6/10	7.5/10	8/10
6. Reporting	18/18	5/18	6.5/18	9/18
7. VAT & Tax Compliance	9/9	4.5/9	2/9	6.5/9
8. Payroll	7/7	3.5/7	0.5/7	0.5/7
9. Fixed Assets	7/7	0/7	3/7	5.5/7
10. Inventory	7/7	4/7	3.5/7	4/7
11. Projects & Time Tracking	6/6	2/6	2.5/6	2/6
12. AI & Automation	12/12	0/12	4/12	4.5/12
13. Document Management	6/6	1/6	3/6	5/6
14. Multi-Currency	5/5	2/5	2/5	2/5
15. Users & Security	7/7	4/7	4/7	5.5/7
16. SA Compliance	5/5	0.5/5	0.5/5	1/5
17. Group / Multi-Entity	5/5	0/5	0/5	0/5
18. Integration & Export	8.5/9	7.5/9	5.5/9	7/9
TOTAL	**149.5/150**	**58.5/150**	**64/150**	**84.5/150**

1. DASHBOARD & KPIS

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Financial dashboard	YES	YES	YES	YES
Custom KPI tiles / ratios	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Cash flow forecast chart	YES	YES	Partial	Add-on

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Executive dashboard	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Configurable widgets	YES	Partial	YES	NO
Multi-company dashboard	YES	NO	NO	NO

2. GENERAL LEDGER

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Chart of accounts	YES	YES	YES	YES
Journal entries	YES	YES	YES	YES
Recurring journals	YES	Std	YES	YES
Opening balances	YES	YES	YES	YES
Lock periods	YES	YES	YES	YES
Cost centres / departments	YES	NO	Plus+	Partial
Business units	YES	NO	Plus+	NO
Multi-segment COA	YES	NO	NO	NO
Year-end close	YES	Partial	Partial	Partial

3. CUSTOMERS / AR

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Invoicing	YES	YES	YES	YES
Quotes / Estimates	YES	YES	YES	YES
Credit notes	YES	YES	YES	YES
Recurring invoices	YES	Std	YES	YES
Customer statements	YES	YES	YES	YES
AR aging (30/60/90/120)	YES	YES	YES	YES
Customer portal	YES	YES	Partial	3rd party
Online payments (PayFast)	YES	Partial	NO	YES
Automated reminders	YES	Add-on	YES	YES
Sales orders	YES	NO	NO	NO
Invoice approval workflow	YES	NO	NO	3rd party
Smart collections (AI)	YES	NO	Partial	NO
Write-offs	YES	Partial	Partial	YES

4. SUPPLIERS / AP

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Supplier invoices	YES	YES	Ess+	YES
Purchase orders	YES	NO	Plus+	YES
Three-way matching (PO/GRN/Inv)	YES	NO	NO	NO

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Goods received notes	YES	NO	NO	NO
AP aging	YES	YES	Ess+	YES
Batch / EFT payments	YES	Partial	Adv	YES
EFT file generation (SA banks)	YES	Partial	NO	3rd party
Bill approval workflow	YES	NO	NO	Partial
DRC VAT	YES	NO	NO	Partial

5. BANKING & RECONCILIATION

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Bank feeds (SA banks)	YES	YES	YES	YES
CSV / OFX import	YES	YES	YES	YES
PDF statement import	YES	NO	NO	NO
Bank rules	YES	YES	YES	YES
AI categorisation	YES	NO	YES	YES
Smart matching	YES	Partial	YES	YES
Bank transfers	YES	YES	YES	YES
Reconciliation reports	YES	YES	YES	YES
Batch reconciliation	YES	Partial	Partial	YES
VLM bank statement parsing	YES	NO	NO	NO

6. REPORTING

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Income statement	YES	YES	YES	YES
Balance sheet	YES	YES	YES	YES
Trial balance	YES	YES	YES	YES
Cash flow statement	YES	Std	YES	YES
Financial ratios	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
KPI scorecard	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Executive summary	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Management report packs	YES	NO	NO	Partial
Board report packs	YES	NO	NO	3rd party
Three-way forecast (P&L+BS+CF)	YES	NO	NO	NO
Trend analysis	YES	NO	Partial	Partial
Waterfall charts	YES	NO	NO	NO
Budget vs actual	YES	Std	Plus+	YES
Custom report builder	YES	NO	Adv	Partial
Report pack PDF export	YES	NO	NO	Partial
CaseWare export	YES	YES	YES	NO

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Consolidated reports	YES	NO	NO	NO
IFRS disclosure notes	YES	NO	NO	NO

7. VAT & TAX COMPLIANCE

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
VAT tracking (15%)	YES	YES	YES	YES
VAT201 preparation	YES	Std	Partial	YES
SARS eFiling integration	YES	YES	NO	YES
EMP201 submission	YES	Payroll	NO	3rd party
EMP501 reconciliation	YES	Payroll	NO	3rd party
IRP5 certificates	YES	Payroll	NO	3rd party
IRP6 provisional tax	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Compliance calendar	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
VAT adjustments	YES	Partial	Partial	YES

8. PAYROLL

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Employee management	YES	Separate	NO	NO
Pay runs	YES	Separate	NO	NO
Payslips (PDF)	YES	Separate	NO	NO
IRP5 certificates	YES	Separate	NO	NO
Leave management (BCEA)	YES	Separate	NO	NO
Overtime calculation (BCEA)	YES	Separate	NO	NO
Integrated with accounting	YES	Partial	Partial	Partial

9. FIXED ASSETS

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Asset register	YES	NO	Adv	YES
Depreciation (SL / RB / SYD)	YES	NO	SL only	SL+RB
SARS wear-and-tear rates	YES	NO	NO	NO
Asset disposal	YES	NO	Partial	YES
Asset categories	YES	NO	Adv	YES
Depreciation schedule report	YES	NO	Adv	YES
Auto-post depreciation	YES	NO	Adv	YES

10. INVENTORY

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Product / item management	YES	Std	YES	YES
Stock level tracking	YES	Std	Plus+	Partial
Weighted average costing	YES	YES	NO	YES
FIFO valuation	YES	NO	YES	Add-on
Stock adjustments	YES	YES	Plus+	YES
Price lists (multiple)	YES	Std	NO	NO
Reorder alerts	YES	Add-on	Plus+	NO

11. PROJECTS & TIME TRACKING

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Project tracking	YES	Add-on	Plus+	Add-on
Time entries	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Add-on
Project profitability	YES	Partial	Plus+	Add-on
WIP tracking	YES	NO	Adv	NO
Billable time to invoice	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Add-on
Recurring invoices from projects	YES	NO	NO	NO

12. AI & AUTOMATION

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
AI transaction categorisation	YES	NO	YES	YES
AI invoice extraction (VLM)	YES	NO	Partial	YES
AI management commentary	YES	NO	NO	NO
Natural language queries	YES	NO	NO	Partial
Anomaly detection	YES	NO	YES	Partial
Cash flow AI forecast	YES	NO	Partial	Add-on
Smart collections (AI)	YES	NO	Partial	NO
Receipt-to-journal (AI)	YES	NO	Partial	YES
Contract-to-recurring (AI)	YES	NO	NO	NO
Continuous close automation	YES	NO	NO	NO
Three-way doc match (AI)	YES	NO	NO	NO
Payslip verification (AI)	YES	NO	NO	NO

13. DOCUMENT MANAGEMENT

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
File attachments	YES	YES	YES	YES
OCR document capture	YES	NO	YES	YES
Vision Language Model (VLM)	YES	NO	NO	Partial
Multi-document upload	YES	NO	Partial	YES
Document validation	YES	NO	NO	Partial
Auto-create invoice from scan	YES	NO	Partial	YES

14. MULTI-CURRENCY

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Foreign currency invoicing	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Prem
Foreign currency bank accounts	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Prem
Auto exchange rates	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Prem
Realised FX gains/losses	YES	Add-on	Ess+	Prem
Included in base price	YES	NO	NO	NO

15. USERS & SECURITY

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Multi-user access	YES	Std	YES	YES
Role-based permissions	YES	YES	Adv	YES
Two-factor auth (2FA)	YES	YES	YES	YES
Audit trail	YES	YES	YES	YES
Approval workflows	YES	NO	NO	3rd party
Data archiving	YES	NO	NO	Partial
POPIA compliance tools	YES	Partial	Partial	Partial

16. SA COMPLIANCE

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
BEE scorecard / reporting	YES	NO	NO	NO
SARS compliance calendar	YES	NO	NO	Add-on
Month-end close checklist	YES	NO	NO	NO
Year-end close	YES	Partial	Partial	Partial
Data subject rights (POPIA)	YES	NO	NO	NO

17. GROUP / MULTI-ENTITY

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
Multi-company management	YES	NO	NO	NO
Consolidated reporting	YES	NO	NO	NO
Intercompany transactions	YES	NO	NO	NO
Group chart of accounts	YES	NO	NO	NO
Elimination entries	YES	NO	NO	NO

18. INTEGRATION & EXPORT

Feature	ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
SA bank feeds	YES	YES	YES	YES
PayFast gateway	YES	Partial	NO	YES
CaseWare export	YES	YES	YES	NO
REST API	YES	YES	YES	YES
Webhooks	YES	Partial	Partial	YES
Sage data import / migration	YES	N/A	NO	Partial
CSV / PDF / Excel export	YES	YES	Partial	YES
Customer portal	YES	YES	Partial	3rd party
Mobile app	PWA	YES	YES	YES

Overall Score

150 features compared across 18 modules

ISAFlow	Sage	QuickBooks	Xero
100%	39%	43%	56%
149.5 / 150	58.5 / 150	64 / 150	84.5 / 150

Key Takeaways

- ISAFlow offers the most comprehensive feature set of any SA cloud accounting platform.
- No competitor offers integrated SA payroll — all require separate paid subscriptions.
- ISAFlow is the only platform with AI management commentary and three-way forecasting.
- Sage has no fixed assets, no purchase orders, and no AI features.
- QuickBooks locks critical features (assets, POs, budgets, custom roles) behind expensive tiers.
- Xero has strong banking/OCR but no group reporting, no BEE, no native SA payroll.
- ISAFlow is the only platform with BEE reporting, SARS compliance calendar, and POPIA tools.
- Multi-currency is included in ISAFlow; it costs extra on Sage, QBO, and Xero.
- ISAFlow includes everything in the base price — no add-on fees.



ISAFlow

Built for South African businesses

app.isaflow.co.za

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